

Applied Materials

Takeaways From Recent Meeting With Investors

Earlier today, we held a virtual NDR for APAC investors, in which we spoke with Mike Sullivan, Corporate Vice President and Head of Investor Relations at Applied Materials Corp. (AMAT). We highlight the key takeaways from our conversation below.

- **Semi Systems revenue growth could be closer to 40% this year...**Mr. Sullivan indicated that ~40% Y/Y growth in AMAT's Semi Systems business feels achievable this year given the continued strengthening in the demand environment over the past 13 weeks, though total company growth will likely fall below that level given mix. He also separately noted that customer cleanroom space remains a practical constraint, which could cap how much further incremental upside there is for Semi Systems to grow beyond this level.
- **AMAT's plan to 2x manufacturing capacity should be viewed as demand preparedness, NOT an implicit WFE forecast...but reflects strength in the demand environment given 8+ quarter visibility (backlog/customer forecasts)....** On its most recent earnings call, AMAT indicated that it was expanding manufacturing capacity to support up to 2x its most recent systems output by 2028. The market extrapolated this to mean that WFE could potentially reach ~\$330-340B by 2028, based on annualizing next-quarter Semi Systems guidance, doubling it, and applying AMAT's WFE share to back into an implied industry WFE number. However, when asked about this, Mr. Sullivan indicated that AMAT was not signaling a formal WFE forecast, but rather trying to ensure it has enough manufacturing capacity to support upside demand if that level of tool demand materializes. In other words, the 2x capacity plan is better understood as a ceiling of what AMAT wants to be capable of serving by 2028, not a base-case expectation for industry WFE.
- **Value-based pricing remains an increasingly important contributor to AMAT's GM framework...**Mr. Sullivan emphasized that AMAT is deeply embedded with customers through collaborative development, and that pricing discussions typically become most relevant as customers move into volume production or expand capacity. Although AMAT generally does not have much room to renegotiate once fabs start high-volume production, capacity expansions create opportunities to revisit pricing across the tool stack (old and new tools). Fundamentally, AMAT believes it has the latitude to implement a value-based pricing framework because its tools help customers deliver better performance, yield, throughput, and downstream economics. In other words, AMAT's strategy is no longer to simply innovate how chips are made, but to innovate their customers' fab economics and share in the economics that they help create.
- **Visibility into 2027 and beyond remains VERY strong, with AI-related markets still driving ~80% of incremental WFE growth...** AMAT remains incrementally more confident in the 2027 WFE outlook than it was 13 weeks ago, with rolling customer order forecasts now extending into 1H28 and some customers starting to discuss their plans into the rest of the decade (e.g., into 2030). Mr. Sullivan noted that AI-related markets (leading-edge F/L, DRAM,

Overweight

AMAT, AMAT US
Price (19 Aug 26):\$496.17

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and advanced packaging) are driving roughly 80% of WFE growth this year, with a similar mix expected to persist in 2027. Upside is coming from a combination of new capacity and customers squeezing more output from existing footprints, including NAND-to-DRAM conversions, repurposing facilities previously used for packaging into chip manufacturing, and modernizing older facilities with newer tools. AMAT also incrementally noted that the vast majority of the 10 new fab projects it saw at customers over the most recent quarter were DRAM-related, and that packaging capacity additions were also meaningful, yet not fully captured in the company's 100+ fab tracker.

- **DRAM remains a strong SAM expansion opportunity, with AMAT's dollar opportunity rising with new tech inflections...**Mr. Sullivan framed the DRAM roadmap as increasingly favorable for AMAT, particularly highlighting CMOS-under-array and how future 3D DRAM architectures increase materials intensity and pull through more of AMAT's strength in deposition, conductor etch, and related process steps. He noted that for every 100k greenfield WSPM, AMAT sees its revenue opportunity rising from roughly \$6B at 6F² to ~\$6.5B at 4F² and ~\$7.5B at 3D DRAM. Moreover, although AMAT's share in 3D architectures has historically been lower given the company's weaker exposure to dielectric etch, Mr. Sullivan noted that future 3D architectures could be more aligned with areas where AMAT has stronger leadership (e.g., epitaxy deposition + conductor etch), creating a potentially meaningful incremental share-gain opportunity.

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Applied Materials (AMAT, AMAT US) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
17-Nov-23	OW	154.81	170
16-Feb-24	OW	187.66	230
17-May-24	OW	214.03	240
16-Aug-24	OW	211.83	250
15-Nov-24	OW	186.00	240
16-May-25	OW	174.75	210
15-Aug-25	OW	188.24	220
14-Nov-25	OW	223.23	260
13-Feb-26	OW	328.39	400
15-May-26	OW	440.56	515
14-Aug-26	OW	534.54	660

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Nov 07, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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Completed 19 Aug 2026 11:17 PM EDT

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